



4.1 Speakers

Altec Lansing 641

Specs: Subwoofer 109 W rms, Satellite Speakers 32 W rms, Frequency Response 27 Hz - 20 KHz, Wired Remote Control for Bass, Treble and Volume

Our Verdict: The sturdy build quality and classy looks of the Altec Lansing 641 PC speakers strike you right when you open the box! This set is power packed with tons of watts to blow you off your seat: the tall subwoofer houses dual drivers in its massive casing. The satellite speakers come with a mid-range driver and a Mylar tweeter, delivering crisp sound. The quality pairing of the subwoofer and speakers helps

deliver awesome treble and bass. Even the DVD audio quality was unmatched by the other quality



speakers such as the Creative Inspire 4400 and the Cyber Acoustic CA 4100. The 641s never gave up even at high volumes.

In one sentence, the Altec Lansing 641 has excellent bass reproduction, extremely good treble, and unmatched clarity. If you happen to have the money, this is the way to go!

Runner-Up: Cyber Acoustic CA 4100

5.1 Speakers

Artis X10

Specs: Subwoofer 90 W rms, Satellite Speakers 28 W rms, Frequency Response 25 Hz-20 KHz, Wireless Remote Control

Our Verdict: The design of this speaker set seems to have been inspired by Bose: the Artis X10 consists of really sturdy and top-quality speakers. In our tests, the bass and treble were both good, but the sound distorted a little at high volumes. The Creative 5.1 Megaworks 550 THX deserves a mention here: it delivered top-quality bass and treble even at high volumes, but that set is

much more expensive.

The X10's subwoofer system is slightly different—it encases a driver facing the ground, and has separate knobs at the back to assign output levels for centre, rear and treble. This is a feature rarely seen in 5.1 speaker systems.



Runner-Up: Creative 5.1 MegaWorks 550 THX

TV-TUNERS

Internal PCI TV-Tuner Cards

Compro VideoMate PVR/FM

Specs: Based on the Philips SAA7134HL Chip, MPEG 1 and 2 Capture Support, FM Radio, Full-Function Remote Control

Our Verdict: Exceptional clarity in TV image quality is the biggest plus of the Compro VideoMate PVT/FM. The accompanying Personal Video Recorder (PVR) software supports capturing video in the MPEG-1 and 2 formats, and also supports the Timeshift feature.

This TV-Tuner could tune into most of the weak signals in our cable TV channel

detection test. We found the FM

tuner, too, quite powerful—it could tune into almost every station there was.

Another great thing is the full-featured, 32-button remote; an FM aerial comes bundled as well. The card is priced moderately for its features, and is therefore a must-buy.



Runner-Up: Mercury TV-Tuner Card

Mitashi DivX-999 DVD Player

Mitashi's DVD players have caught up with the gaining popularity of the DivX format. The new DivX-999 DVD player is sleek and has a trayless slot design. It can play DVDs, VCDs, audio CDs, and the MP3, WMA, XviD, and DivX formats. The playback quality and the setup menu are better than those of the earlier model, the DivX-555 player. Setup options include audio, video, and a password option to prevent kids from operating the device when the parents are away. When you insert a disk which is not a standard VCD or DVD



movie, it provides a explorer-like interface that lets you browse and play compatible media files.

Did we forget to mention that the device plays HD-CDs as well? The Player also offers 5.1-channel audio through both analogue and digital connectivity. You can even connect it to a standard PC monitor. This is a great all-round player, and since it is region-free, you can play any DVD without hassles.